United States: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.

Summary

- None of the 30 placed sectors of the United States sits in the two low-energy-security corners. Its lowest Energy Security percentile is in midstream green hydrogen, where its score equals the sector median of 0.26.[1]
- Its highest Economic Opportunity percentiles are in upstream gas and downstream gas, where it scores higher than 100% and 100% of the other economies scored; the size of its production lifts both.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, its top Strategic Index sectors among its own sectors are midstream batteries and downstream batteries, almost tied; both fall among its sectors with the most policy.[1]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates the United Kingdom highest for the United States, as a reliable supplier. Canada, ranked 2nd, is a priority partner with strong ties today, while China is a strong tie today that the index ranks lower.[1]

1. Energy security risks and why

Of the 30 placed sectors of the United States, 0 sit in the two low-energy-security corners and 30 in the Grow corner, which pairs high opportunity with high energy security. The sectors below are where it compares least well with other economies; none falls below the sector median.[1]

Its lowest Energy Security percentiles are in midstream green hydrogen, downstream nuclear and midstream electric grid, and each still sits in the Grow corner. In midstream green hydrogen, its score of 0.26 equals the median of the 40 economies compared, 0.26. The score rests on a single category, foreign dependency, where the United States scores 0.26 against a median of 0.26.[1]

In downstream nuclear, its score of 0.50 is higher than 76% of the other 66 economies scored. Its energy access and consumption push the score up: its consumption in this sector was 26 GJ per person in 2025.[1,2]

In midstream electric grid, it scores higher than 79% of the other 92 economies. Its trade category pushes the score up: it held 7.3% of world exports of these goods in 2023. For context, its largest suppliers in 2024 were Mexico (28.9% of its imports) and China (11.9%).[1,3,4]

In midstream batteries, a high-priority sector, its Energy Security is higher than 98% of the other 53 economies scored. Its foreign dependency and investment push the score up: counting announced projects, its share of world manufacturing capacity in 2035 would be 15.0%. For context, China supplied 55.0% of its imports of these goods in 2024, and the data record 91 cross-border factory projects in the United States in this sector.[1,4,5,6]

2. Economic opportunities and why

All 30 placed sectors of the United States sit in the two high-opportunity corners. Its highest Economic Opportunity percentiles are in upstream gas, downstream gas and downstream geothermal: it scores higher than 100%, 100% and 100% of the other economies scored in each.[1]

In upstream gas, production and trade push the score up. It produced 38.7 EJ in 2025 and held 15.1% of world exports in 2023; its exports of these goods were USD 62.1 bn in 2024. Its largest markets in 2024 were China (16.5%), South Korea (8.9%) and Mexico (8.8%).[2,3,4,7]

In downstream gas, production and consumption push the score up; its production in this sector was 1,940 TWh in 2025. In downstream geothermal, investment and consumption do the same; both are index measures without a single raw figure.[2]

Its high-priority sectors also score well on this pillar. In midstream batteries, its Economic Opportunity is higher than 98% of the other 53 economies scored, lifted by investment and foreign dependency. For context, Mexico took 39.2% of its exports of these goods in 2024. In downstream batteries, it scores higher than 99% of the other 138 economies, lifted by investment and cost competitiveness.[1,4]

3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

On the paper's weighting, the Strategic Index ranks midstream batteries 1st, downstream batteries 2nd, midstream green hydrogen 3rd and midstream electric grid 4th among the sectors of the United States. These scores are almost tied: neighbours are 0.003, 0.002 and 0.004 apart. With no sector in the Upgrade corner, the paper's rule takes its 3 highest Strategic Index sectors as its high-priority sectors. Its allied pick in the network design is midstream batteries, almost tied with the runner-up, midstream electric grid (just under 0.010 apart).[1,8]

The paper's policy measure counts International Energy Agency policy records, 881 for the United States (586 naming a technology), and reads the Climate Action Tracker rating, Insufficient (November 2024), against each technology.[9,10]

Ranked within the United States, policy activity places midstream batteries and downstream batteries among its sectors with the most policy, and midstream green hydrogen in the middle group. On data-based priority (the Strategic Index without its policy term), downstream batteries ranks only 13th, so its high rank rests on policy activity. Splitting data-based priority and policy activity into thirds, no sector combines top priority with the least policy. Top priority and the most policy coincide in midstream batteries, midstream electric grid, midstream solar, midstream nuclear and midstream wind, while downstream geothermal combines bottom priority with the most policy.[1]

For context, Global Trade Alert records 4,770 active industrial-policy measures for the United States, outside the paper's policy measure: 420 tied to midstream batteries, against 1,341 for midstream electric grid and 1,351 for midstream wind.[11]

4. Partnership priorities and why

The Partnership Strength Index scores how much a partner offers as a reliable supplier, an export market and a place to build supply chains together. From the viewpoint of the United States, it rates the United Kingdom highest, as a reliable supplier. Its best supplier scores are in midstream green hydrogen,

downstream nuclear, midstream nuclear, midstream electric grid and downstream wind. Canada, Germany and the Netherlands follow, ranked 2nd, 3rd and 4th, each also as a reliable supplier.[1]

Several of these partners are close trade partners today. Canada is its 1st trade partner on average across its energy-goods baskets, the United Kingdom its 4th and Germany its 5th. Firms headquartered in Canada and Germany have 23 and 22 cross-border factory projects in the United States. Ireland, ranked 5th, is a priority partner with few ties today: it is only its 33rd trade partner.[1,4,6]

Some large trade partners rank lower on the index. China and Mexico are its 2nd and 3rd trade partners, but the index ranks them 51st and 39th; each is a strong tie today that the index ranks lower. In votes at the United Nations, the United States and China sit in opposite blocs.[1,4,12]

As a partner to the coalition, the United States ranks 1st of 192 economies. In the allied network design, its largest designed shares of coalition production are 31.5% in midstream electric vehicles and 29.5% in midstream batteries.[1,8]

5. Data notes and caveats

Country Insights lists every source (12 October 2026 baseline).

- Scores compare the United States with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms.
- All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings.
- Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order.
- Many allied picks are close calls: in the paper, 37% of them are within 0.01 of the runner-up.
- Factory projects are cross-border solar, wind, battery and electric-vehicle manufacturing projects only, announced projects included, which may never be built; domestic investment is not covered (Cleantech Manufacturing FDI Dataset, edition 2026.10.05, CC BY 4.0; counts by the authors, a joint venture counted under its listed parent).
- Industrial-policy measures from the Global Trade Alert, New Industrial Policy Observatory, October 2026 extract (as of 5 October 2026) are context only, outside the Policy index.

Sources

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